

WC2026 Friends Pool - Rules

Everyone drafts teams from three odds-tiered pots. Your teams earn (and lose) points across the whole tournament from the categories below. Most points at the end wins. The pool leans into chaos

- plenty of ways to score are deliberately perverse, so read carefully.

Goals & shots

Event	Points
Open-play goal	+0.5 each
Free-kick goal	doubles the OPPONENT team's points for that game (scores nothing for you)
Penalty scored - not a shootout	-1.5 each
Penalty scored - in a shootout	-0.5 each
Goal ruled out by VAR	-1 each
0 shots on target in a game	+4
Goal scored OR conceded in the 23rd or 67th minute	+4 (max +4 per game, even if you own both teams)
Each game your team fails to score (clean sheet against you)	-1 (own both teams & it's 0-0 = 0; extra time excluded)
Prime number of total goals (excludes shootout goals)	-3

A free-kick goal still counts toward your team's total-goals tally (so it can still trigger the prime -3 and the fewest-goals award) - it just earns you nothing directly.

The 90'+ rule

- A goal scored at 90:00 or later multiplies ALL of that team's points for that game by -1.

- Two 90'

Red card - roll the dice

- When one of your teams gets a red card, roll a single d6.

- Odd ro

Ranked categories

Each category ranks the top 6 teams across the whole tournament. Positive categories pay 10 / 8 / 5 / 3 / 2 / 1; penalty categories pay the negative of that.

Direction	Points (top 6)	Categories
Reward	10 / 8 / 5 / 3 / 2 / 1	Quickest Goal · Youngest Goalscorer · Fastest Substitute · Fastest Own Goal · Quickest Yellow Card · Longest-Named Goalscorer

Direction	Points (top 6)	Categories
Penalty	-10 / -8 / -5 / -3 / -2 / -1	Oldest Goalscorer · Shortest-Named Goalscorer

- An owner can only win a given category once - if you own both the best and second-best team in it, the second prize rolls down to the next DISTINCT owner.

• Ties sp

Flat awards

- Fewest Goals (whole tournament): +7 to the single team with fewest (tie-split between owners).

• Fewest

Tournament progression

Points for the furthest stage a team reaches, realised in the game they're eliminated.

R32	R16	QF	SF	Runner-up	Winner
+1	+2	+3	+5	+8	+10

- 3rd-place playoff WINNER: -5 (cancels their SF +5, so 3rd place nets 0).

• 4th pla

The draft - pots

The 48 finalists are split into three pots of 16 by their "to reach the quarter-finals" odds: Pot 1 = the 16 strongest, Pot 2 = the middle 16, Pot 3 = the 16 longest shots. The pots keep everyone's squad balanced. (Pot contents are listed separately and finalised once the 48-team field is confirmed.)

Rules locked from the conversation of June 2026. If anything here doesn't match what you expected, flag it before the draft.